System. We planned to make a surface-to-air medium range weapon system with multi-target handling capability during the second phase. DRDL had been known for its pioneering work in the field of anti-tank missiles. We proposed to develop a third generation anti-tank guided missile having ‘fire-and-forget’ capabilities. Al my col eagues were pleased with the proposal. They saw an opportunity to pursue afresh activities initiated long ago. But I was not entirely satisfied. I longed to revive my buried dream of a Re-entry Experiment Launch Vehicle (REX). I persuaded my col eagues to take up a technology development project to generate data for use in the design of heat shields. These shields were required for building up capability to make longrange missiles in the future.

I made a presentation in the South Block. The presentation was presided over by the Defence Minister of the time R Venkataraman, and attended by the three Service Chiefs: General Krishna Rao, Air Chief Marshal Dilbagh Singh and Admiral Dawson. The Cabinet Secretary, Krishna Rao Sahib, Defence Secretary, SM Ghosh and Secretary, Expenditure, R Ganapathy were present. Everyone seemed to have al sorts of doubts—